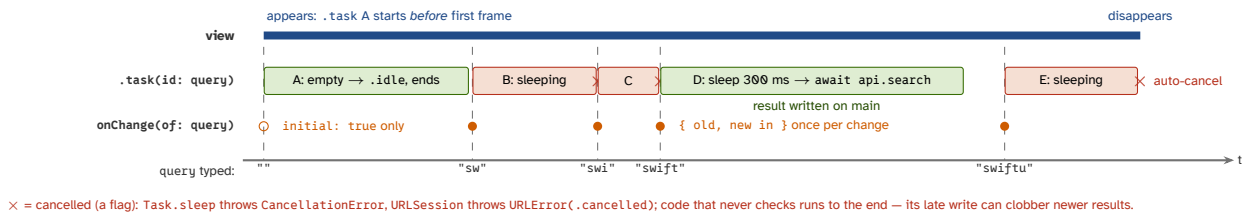


In one line: SwiftUI owns the **lifetime** of async work: `.task` starts with the view and is **cancelled** when the view goes away or its id changes. Views are **@MainActor**: writing state after `await` is safe, blocking the main actor is your bug. Truth lives in `@State` / `@Observable`; effects hang off `.task(id:)`, `onChange`, `.refreshable`.



How it works

- **.task { }** (15): starts before the view appears, priority .userInitiated; cancelled if the view disappears first. **.task(id:)**: a new Equatable id value cancels the old task and starts a fresh one. Current docs: created with Task.immediate — synchronous up to the first await.
 - **Cancellation is cooperative**: only a flag; Task.sleep, URLSession, try Task.checkCancellation() turn it into an error.
 - **Isolation**: View is @MainActor @preconcurrency (Xcode 16 SDK; before, only body). init, body, actions, the .task closure run on main; await suspends without blocking. Swift 6.2 approachable concurrency: a nonisolated async func runs on the caller's actor; CPU work: @concurrent.
 - **Models**: @State private var model = Model() owns an @Observable; pass it down as a plain let; a child needing \$model.name declares @Bindable var model (or @Bindable var m = model in body). Load in .task, not init.
 - **onChange(of:initial:_:)** (17): { old, new in } or { }; initial: true also fires on appear; main actor, keep it short. (of:perform:) deprecated.
 - **.refreshable** (15): pull-to-refresh; spinner stays **until the closure returns**; env \.refresh for custom views.
 - **Search**: .searchable(text: \$q) (15) + .task(id: q) with a sleep = debounce and cancel-previous; searchScopes, searchSuggestions (16).
 - **AsyncImage** (15): shared URLSession; phases empty / success / failure; no downsampling. **iOS 27** adds HTTP caching, init(request:), .asyncImageURLSession(_:).
 - **Focus** (15): @FocusState var f: Field?, .focused(\$f, equals: .email), .onSubmit { f = .password }.
- Optional-driven UI**: .sheet(item:),
.alert(_:isPresented:presenting:), now
alert(_:item:); nil = dismissed.

Example — debounced search

```
enum Phase<T> { case idle, loading, loaded(T), failed(String) }
struct SearchView: View {
    @State private var query = ""
    @State private var phase: Phase<Hit> = .idle
    let api: SearchAPI
    var body: some View {
        ResultsList(phase: phase)
            .searchable(text: $query)
            .task(id: query) {
                // restart per keystroke
                guard !query.isEmpty else { phase = .idle; return }
                do {
                    try await Task.sleep(for: .milliseconds(300)) // debounce
                    phase = .loading
                    phase = .loaded(try await api.search(query)) // on main
                } catch {
                    // incl. URLError
                    if !Task.isCancelled { phase = .failed("\(error)") }
                }
            }
            .refreshable { await reload() } // spinner until done
    }
}
```

Which tool for which job

load once per appearance	.task { }
reload when an input changes	.task(id: input)
consume a stream for the view's life	.task { for await v in seq { } }
cheap sync effect on a change	onChange(Of:initial:)
user pull / refresh action	.refreshable { await }
button kicks off work	Task { } in the action — lives on; keep the handle to cancel
observe a model outside views	Observations / withObservationTracking

Traps

- ! `.onAppear { Task { await load() } }` — unstructured: **not** cancelled on disappear, outlives the screen.
- ! `try? await Task.sleep(...)` swallows cancellation — the stale “debounced” search still fires. Let it throw, or check `Task.isCancelled`.
- ! Showing `URLError.cancelled` as an error — every keystroke flashes a failure.
- ! JSON decode / image resize inside `.task` runs on the **main actor** — hitches.
- ! `.refreshable { Task { ... } }` returns at once — spinner vanishes.
- ! `.id(UUID())` / unstable identity re-creates the view: `.task` re-runs, duplicate fetches.
- ! The opposite: a split-view detail keeps its identity while selection changes — a plain `.task` never re-runs and shows the old item. Key it: `.task(id: item.id)`.
- ! `onChange` that writes the value it watches (directly or via layout) — a feedback loop; runtime log: “tried to update multiple times per frame” (*unverified*).

Remember

“The view’s life is the task’s life; the id is its restart button; main actor by default.”